

sphenoidal sinus

Cavity hollowed out of the sphenoid bone of the skull; it connects with the nasal fossae and warms inhaled air.

nasopharynx

Section of the pharynx (meeting point of the respiratory and digestive tracts) through which the mouth connects with the nasal fossae and where the Eustachian tube opens.

Eustachian tube

Tube connecting the middle ear to the nasopharynx; it allows outside air to pass through, thus equalizing air pressure on both sides of the ear drum.

Bowman's gland

Gland of the olfactory mucosa that secretes mucus.

olfactory cell

Neuron one end of which has cilia that convert chemical stimuli into nerve impulses, which will be transmitted to the olfactory bulb.

soft palate

Muscular membranous section of the wall separating the mouth from the nasal cavity; it has a role especially in ingesting food and speaking.

uvula

Fleshy movable appendage that is an extension of the posterior edge of the soft palate; it aids in ingesting food and speaking.

olfactory bulb

Nerve structure where fibers of the olfactory nerve end; it receives nervous impulses from the mucous membrane and transmits them to the olfactory tract.

axon

Extension of olfactory cell, communicating nerve impulses to the olfactory bulb.

mucus

Runny secretion produced by the Bowman's glands, which moistens the cilia at the end of the olfactory cells to dissolve odoriferous molecules.

